

Daniel I. Rivera

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United States Marine Corps Veteran | Veteran Tax Credit Eligible

Education

The University of Texas at San Antonio | San Antonio, TX

- *M.S. in Medical Laboratory Sciences (NAACLS Accredited)*
- *Post-Baccalaureate Studies in Advanced Biological Sciences*
- *B.S. in Public Health (Concentration in Epidemiology)*

Expected 08/2027

2016 - 2020

05/2015

Academic Clinical Laboratory Experience

UT San Antonio Teaching Laboratories |

08/2025 - 08/2026

- **Diagnostic Microbiology & Mycology (MLSC 5011 / 5012):** Plated clinical cultures, evaluated selective/differential media, and performed Gram and AFB stains. Executed automated VITEK ID/AST, Kirby-Bauer susceptibility testing, and identified anaerobic bacteria, fungi, and parasites.
- **Immunodiagnosics & Serology (MLSC 5001):** Performed serological agglutination, flocculation, and lateral flow immunoassays; evaluated ANA immunofluorescence patterns, serial dilutions/titers, and quality control validation.
- **Immunohematology / Blood Bank (MLSC 5006):** Performed tube, solid phase (Werfen SPRCA / Capture Technology), and Ortho MTS Anti-IgG gel card methodologies for ABO/Rh typing, discrepancy resolution, antibody screening, panel identification, crossmatching, and fetal screens for RhIG.
- **Hematology & Hemostasis (MLSC 5004):** Performed manual 100-cell differentials (evaluating RBC morphology, leukocyte inclusions, and acute leukemias), operated HORIBA ABX Micros automated CBC analyzer and automated coagulation analyzers, and performed reticulocyte counts and ESR.
- **Clinical Chemistry (MLSC 5008):** Operated ACE Axcel™ Chemistry Analyzer (with ISE module) and Sebia SPEP; monitored Westgard QC multi-rules and resolved out-of-control runs.
- **Urinalysis & Body Fluids (MLSC 5009):** Performed macroscopic, automated chemical reagent strip (Siemens Clinitek), and microscopic sediment analysis on urine; conducted manual cytological, chemical, and microscopic examination of CSF, synovial, and serous fluids.

Work Experience

Infectious Disease Clinic, HIV Evaluation Unit | San Antonio Military Medical Center (SAMMC) | Internship

06/2014 - 11/2014

- Co-authored peer-reviewed research analyzing the diagnostic efficacy of extragenital nucleic acid amplification testing (NAAT) for high-risk populations, published in the Medical Surveillance Monthly Report (MSMR).
- Maintained strict data integrity for a longitudinal clinical database tracking 600 HIV-positive patients and 4,000 unique Gonorrhea and Chlamydia diagnostic test results.
- Executed statistical data analysis and quality control validation using IBM SPSS to identify diagnostic discrepancies and analyze prevalence, incidence, and percent change across different anatomical collection sites.

South Texas Center for Emerging Infectious Diseases | UT San Antonio | Laboratory Assistant

09/2013 - 05/2014

- Executed Polymerase Chain Reaction (PCR) protocols for DNA isolation and genotyping, consistently maintaining sterile technique and contamination controls.
- Performed histological tissue processing, microtomy, and specialized staining to mount samples for automated or microscopic analysis.
- Compounded chemical reagents and fixative solutions following precise laboratory formulas to ensure proper tissue preservation and bench disinfection.
- Maintained laboratory inventory and chemical hygiene standards, ensuring all reagents, tools, and consumables were stocked and ready for automated workflows.

San Antonio Sleep Centers | San Antonio, Texas | Sleep Lab Technician

02/2008 - 01/2011

United States Marine Corps | Camp Pendleton, California | Administration Clerk/ Chief Mail Coordinator

10/1999 - 10/2003

PUBLICATIONS

Patterson, S. B., Rivera, D., Sunil, T. S., & Okulicz, J. F. (2014). Evaluation of extragenital screening for gonorrhea and chlamydia in HIV-infected active-duty Air Force members. Medical Surveillance Monthly Report (MSMR), 21(11), 7-9.

Affiliations/Interests

International Clinical Cytometry Society (ICCS) | Member

2026 - Present

American Society for Clinical Pathology (ASCP) | Member

2025 - Present

Texas Association for Clinical Laboratory Science (TACLS) | Member

2025 - Present

Big Brothers Big Sisters of South Texas | Youth Mentor

2008 - 2015

Technical/Clinical Skills

Laboratory Competencies: Brightfield & Fluorescence Microscopy, PCR Genotyping, Tissue Processing, Histological Staining, Reagent Preparation, Sterile Technique, Quality Control (QC) Protocols. **Software & Data Analysis:** Jamovi, Microsoft Excel (Moderate). **Languages & Certifications:** Fluent in Spanish (Written/Verbal), CPR Certified.